Vibethon: Participant Handbook and Guide

Organized by ENCIDE | Mar Athanasius College of Engineering

1. Event Overview and Themes

Vibethon is designed to challenge developers and innovators to build impactful, robust, and functional artificial intelligence solutions. All projects must align directly with one of the following four core tracks:

- **AI for Assisting Creativity**
    - **Focus:** Human-AI collaboration, creative workflow ergonomics, and user control.
    - **Scope:** Systems where artificial intelligence serves as an amplifier or co-creator across generative design, digital media, writing, music, or ideation, maintaining granular creator control over the final output.
- **AI for Cybersecurity**
    - **Focus:** Practical threat modeling, vulnerability detection, false positive mitigation, and privacy preservation.
    - **Scope:** Defensive applications including automated code auditing, proactive anomaly detection, phishing defense, and privacy-preserving data workflows.
- **AI for Humanity**
    - **Focus:** Social impact, healthcare, education, sustainability, accessibility, bias mitigation, and low-resource viability.
    - **Scope:** Purpose-driven technologies addressing critical societal challenges, remaining accessible and resilient in low-bandwidth or resource-constrained settings.
- **AI for Developers**
    - **Focus:** Measurable productivity gains, IDE/CLI/CI-CD integration, and automated debugging, testing, or documentation.
    - **Scope:** High-utility developer tools that integrate directly into existing programming workflows, eliminating repetitive development overhead.

2. Evaluation Structure

The evaluation process is structured into two sequential stages:

1. **Round 1: Preliminary Selection (Internal Review Panel)**
    - Conducted by our internal engineering and mentor panel.
    - Focuses on technical verification, functional stability, code authenticity, prompt architecture, and implementation depth.
    - **Only 10 teams will be selected to round 2**
2. **Round 2: Grand Finale (External Industry Judges)**

    - Evaluated by working industry professionals.
    - Shifts strongly toward the **business and commercial viability** of the product, including product-market fit, scalable monetization, go-to-market feasibility, user experience polish, and live pitch defense.

3. Round 1: Preliminary Selection Rubric (50 Points Total)

All submissions must pass three preliminary eligibility checks:

- **Code Authenticity:** Verifiable repository commit history confirming work built during the hackathon.
- **Functional Live Build:** A functioning local or deployed build (slide decks alone are ineligible).
- **Theme Alignment:** Clear and unambiguous connection to one of the four competition themes.

Preliminary Scoring Matrix

Category	Max Score	Key Focus Areas
Functional Completeness & Stability	10	Core user flow runs without crashing, dynamic input handling, real features vs. static UI shells.
UI/UX & User Flow Design	10	Clean layout, intuitive navigation, loading indicators, error messaging.
AI Implementation & Depth	10	Real AI/ML pipeline (agents, RAG, custom embeddings, fine-tuning) vs. single-prompt wrapper, commit history proof.
Prompt Engineering & System Architecture	10	Prompt structure and clarity, system prompt architecture, guardrails, and safety handling.
Theme Alignment & Relevance	5	Meaningful fit in one of the 4 themes, genuine problem definition.

Category	Max Score	Key Focus Areas
Novelty & Approach	5	Unique technical angle or solution design vs. boilerplate clones.

4. Round 2: Grand Finale Judging Rubric (100 Points Total)

Shortlisted finalists present their solution to an external panel of industry professionals. This round places decisive emphasis on the commercial, product, and business dimensions:

Final Selection Scoring Matrix

Category	Max Score	Key Focus Areas
Live Execution & Product Reliability	25	End-to-end live testing, zero unhandled crashes, handling edge cases/unpredictable inputs, API resilience & rate limit handling, real output vs. hardcoded mocks.
UI/UX, Design & Accessibility	20	Production-grade visual polish, frictionless user journeys, responsive interface, loading states for AI generation, visual presentation of complex AI outputs, accessibility.
Product-Market Fit & Practical Utility	20	Clearly defined persona, burning pain point, tangible ROI / time saved, distinct moat over basic LLM wrappers/ChatGPT.
Business Viability & Scalability	20	Realistic monetization (B2B SaaS, usage tiers, API), unit economics (token cost vs. revenue), scalable architecture, data privacy/governance.
Pitch Delivery & Q&A Defense	15	Live demo clarity, crisp problem framing within time limit,

Category	Max Score	Key Focus Areas
		technical poise under tough Q&A scrutiny.

5. Standardized Rating Benchmark Scale

Evaluators use the following benchmark tiers to calibrate marks:

- **Exceptional:** Flawless execution, highly innovative, robust against edge cases, and ready for real-world application.
- **Strong:** Solid execution with minor flaws, clear utility, thoughtful architecture, and good design.
- **Average:** Functional but lacks polish, basic implementation of core concepts, and reliance on common templates.
- **Below Average:** Incomplete, buggy, unhandled errors, or fails to address the core problem.

6. Strategic Advice for Participants

1. **Prioritize Working Execution Over Feature Count:** Ensure your core prototype operates end-to-end without crashing. A fully functional minimum viable product with clean user flow consistently outperforms an over-scoped build filled with non-functional buttons.
2. **Build Meaningful Technical Depth:** Move beyond surface-level wrappers. Focus on creating value through structured workflows, multi-step logic, custom data integration, or thoughtful prompt and system architecture.
3. **Keep the User Journey Intuitive:** Deliver a clean, responsive interface that feels seamless to navigate, communicates system state clearly, and renders outputs in a readable, well-structured format.
4. **Prepare Your Business Case for the Finale:** Because Round 2 is evaluated by industry leaders, be prepared to defend your product-market fit, target audience, unit economics, competitive moat, and long-term viability beyond the hackathon stage.